

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

POSTSCRIPT GONE AWRY

The mention of the Israel-Hamas war in the October 9 Congress Working Committee (CWC) resolution has triggered an internal conflict among the party's senior leaders. There was reportedly a decision to omit the war; party president **Mallikarjun Kharge** had said the party needed to focus on demanding a caste census. Yet, a statement expressing distress over the conflict and support for the "Palestinian struggle for self-rule" was sneaked into the press note later released by **K.C. Venugopal**, the party general secretary in-charge of organisation. There was no condemnation of the Hamas attack. All fingers are now pointing towards communication chief **Jairam Ramesh** and Venugopal, whose Kerala compatriot Ramesh Chennithala first demanded the inclusion of the Middle East conflict in the CWC resolution.



NEW AVATAR

The Pawar family has never been known to wear their religion on their sleeve. So, when Maharashtra deputy chief minister and family rebel **Ajit Pawar** went on a temple run during the recent Ganesh Utsav, sceptics questioned if it had anything to do with his newly minted alliance with the BJP and its Hindutva ideals. Now, there is speculation again on Pawar's moves during the Navratri festival which is due soon. Will the Maharashtra *manoos* embark on the second leg of his temple run?

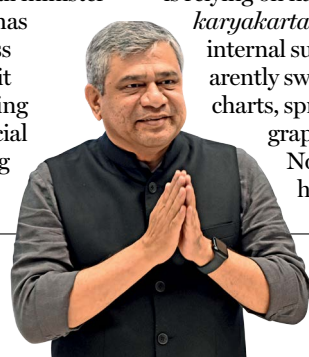
DK on Loan



With ticket distribution likely to stir rebel trouble when it gets under way later this month, the Congress has decided to station **D.K. Shivakumar** as its point person in Telangana, given his success in the recent Karnataka polls. Congress workers are said to be scouting for a furnished house in Hyderabad for him to stay in to participate in the electioneering and trouble-shoot for the party. But when the Karnataka deputy CM is away, who does his work at home?

STATS OF THE STATE

Now donning the additional hat of BJP co-in-charge for Madhya Pradesh, rail minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** has got down to business in right earnest. Be it monitoring messaging on traditional or social media, or generating local, micro-level talking points or door-to-door engagements, Vaishnaw is relying on hard data from *karyakartas* and the party's internal surveys. He is apparently swamped in pie charts, spreadsheets and graphs these days. Now to see if the hard work pays.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

IRE GROUND

The Rashtriya Janata Dal, of course, needs **Lalu Prasad**, but even the BJP can't seem to do without invoking the RJD patriarch's name. When party president J.P. Nadda was in Patna recently, he reminded Lalu how he had named his first daughter Misa because he was arrested under the Maintenance of Internal Security Act (MISA) during the Emergency, alluding to the shift in his stand from being anti-Congress to pro-Congress. RJD insiders believe Lalu has once again become a bugbear for the BJP after, at 14.3 per cent, his Yadav vote bank emerged as the single-largest caste bloc in the recently concluded caste survey in Bihar, dashing the BJP's hopes of riding a Hindu wave. Hence their ire.



Kaushik Deka with Avishek Ghosh Dastidar, Amitabh Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon and Dhaval S. Kulkarni